



NOW ACCEPTING APPLICATIONS FROM USC STUDENTS

Graduate Research Assistant: Computational Analysis of Collective Bargaining Agreements

Fall 2026 | Remote | Applications received by September 18 receive priority

THE OPPORTUNITY

The USC Department of Political Science and International Relations is seeking a master's or PhD student for a research project on collective bargaining and the governance of artificial intelligence in the workplace. The project is constructing and analyzing a large, cross-national corpus of agreements from North America, Europe, and Latin America.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Design reproducible web-scraping pipelines for new countries and institutional repositories.
- Work with dynamic websites, APIs, HTML, and large collections of PDF documents.
- Develop workflows for text extraction, OCR, language detection, and machine translation.
- Design and harmonize a common metadata structure across countries.
- Develop record-linkage, deduplication, and data-quality validation procedures.
- Construct and validate measures of provisions in collective bargaining agreements.
- Apply dictionaries, embeddings, supervised classification, clustering, or LLM-assisted annotation.
- Assess measurement quality through human validation, precision, recall, and intercoder agreement.
- Produce technical documentation and research outputs; coordinate with and guide team members as appropriate.

USC STUDENTS ONLY

Applicants must be currently enrolled USC master's or PhD students. Please apply only if you meet the qualifications.

APPOINTMENT

Hours
Approximately 10-20 per week

Period
Fall 2026; start by the end of September, with possible renewal

Pay
Anticipated \$20.00 per hour, subject to assignment, qualifications, and final approval

Arrangement
Remote

RESEARCH FOCUS

Collective bargaining
Workplace technology
Artificial intelligence
Worker data and monitoring
Training and job security



Qualifications & Application

ELIGIBILITY

Applicants must be currently enrolled master's or PhD students at USC in data science, computer science, statistics, economics, public policy, or a related field.

REQUIRED QUALIFICATIONS

- Strong programming skills in Python.
- Experience with NLP, embeddings, transformer models, or large language models.
- Experience cleaning, merging, and managing complex, large datasets.
- Ability to work independently and troubleshoot technical problems.
- Strong written communication and documentation skills.

PREFERRED QUALIFICATIONS

- Web scraping and automated data collection.
- Text-as-data analysis.
- Processing PDFs, scanned documents, or multilingual text.
- Knowledge of collective bargaining, labor politics, or comparative political economy.
- Fluency in Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Finnish, Swedish, or another relevant language.

PhD eligibility: Appointments are subject to university requirements and approval, including limits associated with existing TA, RA, or fellowship appointments.

PROJECT & TEAM

Supported by OpenAI and Schmidt Sciences' AI at Work program, this project brings together faculty, postdoctoral researchers, and research assistants from institutions including the University of Zurich and OpenAI. The role contributes to original research spanning labor, political economy, computational social science, and artificial intelligence.

HOW TO APPLY

Email the following materials:

- A CV.
- A one-page statement describing your research interests and relevant technical experience.
- Your availability during the semester.
- Optional but recommended: a code sample, GitHub repository, research paper, or data project.

SEND TO

gonzalez.rostani@usc.edu

SUBJECT LINE

"CBA Research Assistant"

PRIORITY DEADLINE

September 18, 2026

Applications received by this date will receive priority consideration.

QUESTIONS?

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Assistant Professor

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